

NOOR POST • EVERYONE ELSE

**Abbas carried water  
toward the camp, for the  
children, at Karbala.**

FOR

**[Child's name]**





**Noor Post**  
[ Return address — not set ]

EVERYONE ELSE • ABBAS  
IBN ALI • INSIDE THE  
FLAP

## Open together.

• is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, • and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

## FACT PANEL

# Abbas ibn Ali

- **Who he was.** Son of Imam Ali and Umm al-Banin, and Imam Husayn's half-brother. Grew up close to the family he would stay beside until the end.
- **His role at Karbala.** Standard-bearer — the one who carried the flag, and the one sent when something dangerous needed doing and trust mattered more than rank.
- **The water.** On the final days, the camp's access to the river was cut off. Abbas broke through to it, filled a waterskin for the children, and turned back without drinking himself.
- **Why he is remembered for it.** Not the fighting alone — the choice, at the water's edge, thirsty himself, to carry it to others first.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Abbas carried water toward the camp, for the children, at Karbala.*

He was killed at Karbala, on the day of Ashura, on his way back to the tents with the water.

EVERYONE ELSE · ABBAS IBN ALI

# The Water He Did Not Drink



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- On the last days at Karbala, water stopped reaching the camp. The river was right there, close enough to see the light on it. Reaching it was not close at all — it was guarded on purpose, and getting past that guard was the whole problem the camp had left.
  - **Why would they block water?**
  - To end the standoff without a fight. Thirst does the work a battle would otherwise have to do, slowly, on everyone at once, including the children.
  - **Who tried anyway?**
  - Abbas. Imam Husayn's brother, and the one everyone in the camp trusted to carry the flag and to get anything dangerous done that needed doing, because he was the one who would actually go.
  - **Did he get through?**
  - He got through. Fought his way past the guard to the water's edge, filled a waterskin for the children back at the tents, and knelt down at the river himself, alone, with nobody watching to check what he did next.
  - **He must have been so thirsty.**

- Days of it. Nothing to drink, in that heat, in armour, for far longer than anyone should have to manage — the kind of thirst that makes it hard to think about anything else at all.

#### ◦ **So he drank?**

- He had his hand in the water. And he thought about the children waiting behind him who had had nothing for three days, and he could not make himself swallow while they were still waiting on the other side of that river.

#### ◦ **So he didn't drink at all?**

- Not one mouthful. He filled the skin for them, stood back up still thirsty, and turned around to carry it home instead of finishing what he had earned the right to finish.

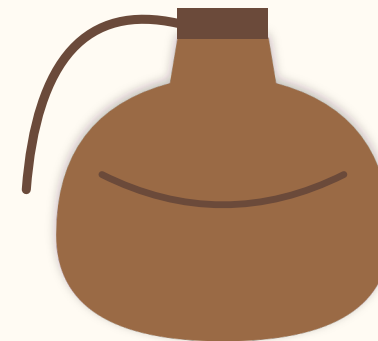
#### ◦ **Could you do that? Say yes or no, out loud, before we finish.**

- Most people, honestly, are not sure until it's their own hand in the water. It is the hardest kind of hard there is — not one moment of it, but choosing it again with every single step of the way back.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**He carried the water the whole way, and never once for himself.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION • 15/39

IMAM HUSAYN SAID

**“Favors should be like the  
heavy rain that covers the  
pious and the sinful.”**

UNVERIFIED SELECTION

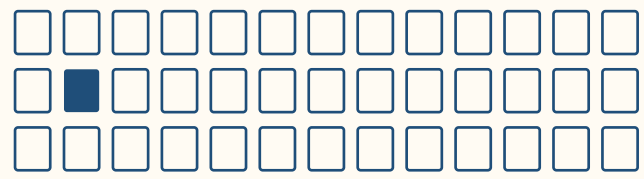
Imam Husayn



NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT • THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

## The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.  
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected  
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

**Be kind to everyone, the way rain falls  
on everyone.**

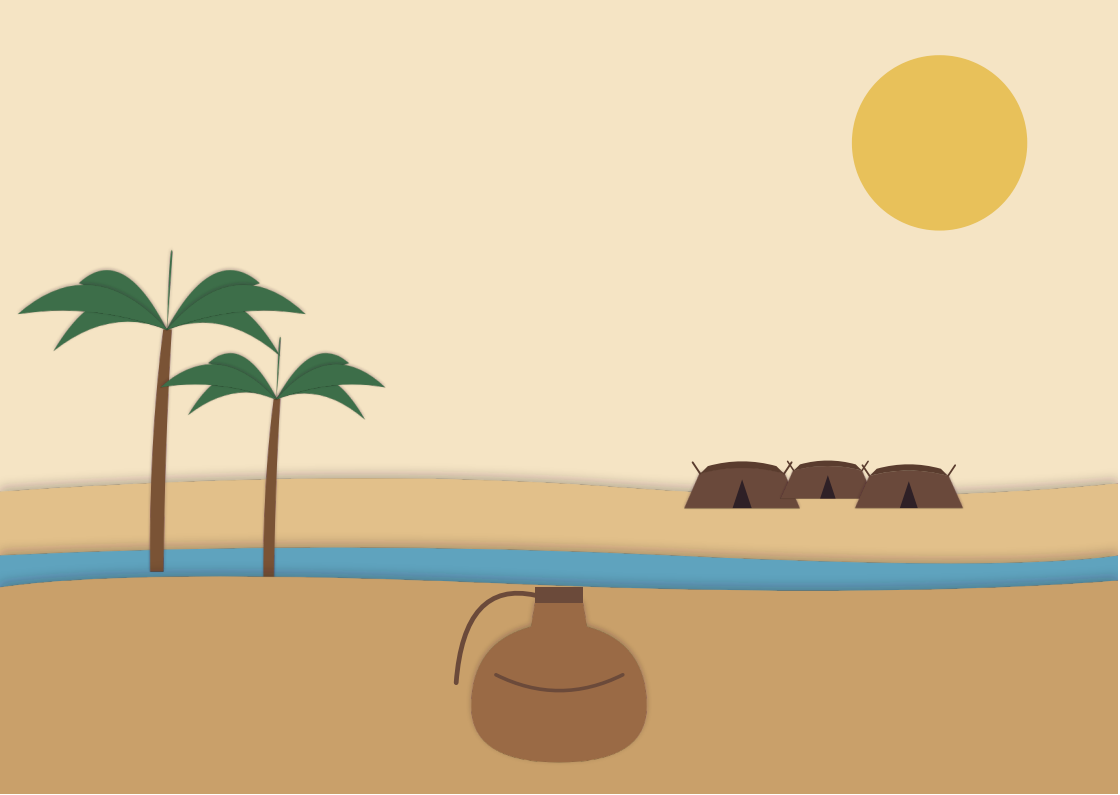
Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

*Tuhaf al-Uqul*, short maxims of Imam al-Husayn, no. 3. Translated by  
Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.



**Abbas ibn Ali**





# We opened this one together.

- \_\_\_\_\_
- \_\_\_\_\_

*Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.*

STAMP

**Noor Post**

[ Return address — not set ]

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